



Late flourish

While contributions from Samson and Ishan took the limelight, Dube's crucial support in the final phases flew under the radar.

During the broadcast of Sunday's final, Ian Bishop mentioned that if nobody was talking about Dube, it meant he had done his job. Indeed, that was the case even in the final as Dube plundered James Neesham for 24 runs off the final over.

In hindsight, India already had enough on the board, but the late surge allowed the co-host to tighten the noose around New Zealand heading into the second innings.

Even in the semifinal against England, Dube contributed a significant 43 runs off just 25 balls while taking on England's prime wicket-taking threat, Adil Rashid.

Among batters who faced at least 30 balls in the death overs in this World Cup, only Jacks and Sherfane Rutherford had a better average than Dube's 74, and only three batters scored at a higher tempo than his strike rate of 211.42.



Leading from the front

Leading up to this T20 World Cup, India had been a trailblazer. However, during its title defence, India was not firing on all cylinders. Abhishek and Varun Chakaravathy had been the biggest match-winners for the side over the last year but struggled in the World Cup.

But Suryakumar Yadav, himself under fire for a batting slump, aced his role as a leader. He showed faith in both players, and it paid off. Abhishek chipped in with a blazing fifty in the final, while Varun finished as the joint-highest wicket-taker.

Even with Samson, Suryakumar made a timely change to the top order to fix India's opening muddle.

On multiple occasions, the Indian captain held himself back to promote others when a match-up or situation demanded. Dube's promotion to No. 4 to take on Rashid in the semifinal was a case in point.

Though India already had two T20 World Cup trophies, Suryakumar's team stands out since it braved the burden of expectations. First, to live up to the reputation as the best team, and then to deliver in front of a home crowd.